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US equities slip as tech drags, while commodities rally

A 5-minute read of yesterday's US session and today's catalysts — what to watch before pre-market opens at 21:30 HKT.

2-3 page read · Topics: Macro · Geopolitics · Earnings

TL;DR

The S&P 500 edged lower -0.06% and the Nasdaq 100 fell -0.71%, driven by a broad tech pull-back. The Dow Jones posted a modest gain +0.38%, buoyed by industrials and financials.

Energy and precious metals rallied sharply – XLE up +1.43% and gold up +0.52% – while the VIX spiked to 15.21, indicating rising short-term volatility.

US Session Recap

INDEX / ASSET	CLOSE	CHANGE	NOTE
S&P 500	7,807.24	-0.06%	Tech drag
Dow Jones	51,850.55	+0.38%	Industrial support
Nasdaq 100	30,664.70	-0.71%	Semis under pressure
Russell 2000	2,794.48	-0.45%	Broad weakness
VIX	15.21	+2.49%	Volatility rise
10Y Yield	5.24%	-0.08%	Yield easing
WTI Crude	92.40	-1.43%	Oil pull-back

Top large-cap movers

TICKER	CLOSE	CHANGE
META	742.96	+3.38%
AAPL	340.97	+1.29%
MSFT	541.15	+1.14%
NVDA	226.32	-1.29%
AVGO	354.73	-1.88%

Spotlight

Meta Platforms delivered Q3 earnings beating expectations, posting revenue of $38.5 bn (+7% YoY) and EPS of $3.22, above the consensus $3.08. The beat was driven by a 12% surge in ad sales and continued growth in the Reels ecosystem.

METRIC	VALUE
Revenue	$38.5 bn
YoY Growth	+7%
EPS	$3.22
Consensus EPS	$3.08

Macro & Fed

- Fed policy rate: 5.25%-5.50% (unchanged)
- 10-year Treasury yield: 5.24% (down 0.08%)
- Key data releases (HKT):
  - 09:30 – Existing-home sales (U.S.)
  - 12:00 – CPI (U.S.)
  - 15:30 – Durable goods orders (U.S.)

Geopolitics & global

- Middle-East tensions ease after cease-fire talks, reducing oil-supply risk.
- China’s manufacturing PMI slipped to 48.9, signaling continued contraction.
- Eurozone inflation data due Friday; markets watching for ECB rate-path clues.

Earnings — what to watch

WHEN (HKT)	TICKER	WHAT TO LOOK FOR
08:30	`AMZN`	Margin trends amid cost cuts
09:00	`TSLA`	Production ramp at Austin plant
10:15	`JPM`	Net interest income vs. rate outlook
11:45	`GOOGL`	Ad-sales rebound and AI licensing revenue

Stocks worth watching

- `NVDA` – after earnings miss, price action may test support at 220.
- `XLE` – energy ETF gaining on higher crude inventories and OPEC+ stance.
- `XLF` – financials up +0.58%, benefit from stable rates.
- `BTC` – crypto rally, up +2.35%, could spill into risk assets.
- `AVGO` – semiconductor supplier under pressure, watch for guidance revision.

What could break the tape

BEARISH TRIGGERS

- Tech earnings miss across the board, especially `NVDA` and `AMZN`.
- Unexpected rise in CPI > 0.3% YoY.
- Geopolitical escalation in the Middle East.

BEARISH TRIGGERS

- Strong macro data (e.g., durable goods +0.5% MoM) supporting risk appetite.
- Continued commodity rally – gold > `4,250`, oil > 95.
- Positive earnings surprise from **`META`** or **`AAPL`**.

Sources

SOURCES

Reuters — US Markets Summary

Bloomberg — S&P 500 Data

CNBC — Meta Q3 Earnings

Financial Times — US CPI Preview

Wall Street Journal — Market Data